

Features of the analysis of business processes of the company (on the example of customer service in a travel agency)

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ABSTRACT

Currently, for the effective development of the activities of any company, modern information technologies and information systems are used. In the conditions of digitalization of the economy, special attention is paid to business processes of interaction with customers of companies, the main requirement of which is the mobility of the proposed operations and services. The use of modern tools to improve business processes is designed to increase the efficiency of any company. Depending on the scope of the company, different tools are used. In this regard, it is advisable to describe and analyze the activities of the company, and then its business processes. The result a list of business processes requiring improvement will be.

This paper discusses the features and methods of automating business processes using digital technologies, analyzes the activities of the company (using the example of a travel agency), describes its main business processes. The theoretical and methodological description of the features of automation of the company showed the possibility of using modern IT tools to increase the competitiveness of the company and the level of customer satisfaction. As a result of the research of the activities of the travel agency «1001 tour», an analysis of external and internal factors affecting the company. Description of business processes showed the need to improve interaction with customers through the introduction of mobile technology. The theoretical significance of the study is to describe the features of improving customer service. The practical significance of this work is due to the possibility of using the results as a basis for developing models of the main business processes in the notions «as is» and «to be», preparing a project for introducing innovations and conducting a preliminary assessment of its economic efficiency.

CCS CONCEPTS

•Social and professional topics → Professional topics → Management of computing and information systems → Project and people management → Project management techniques

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KEYWORDS

Business process; business process automation; SWOT analysis; information technology; mobile technology; digital economy.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Each economic object (organizations, enterprises, companies) are complex, developing and managed systems. Targeted impact on the system, leading to a change or preservation of its state is provided by management. The main functions of managing an economic object are planning, accounting, analysis, control and regulation. Automation of information flows of the company will improve the management of its activities. For this, it is necessary to implement modern information technologies (IT). Any enterprise should be able to effectively collect, process and use information as soon as possible. ITs is constantly evolving, and the quality of enterprise management and its competitiveness depend on how actively they are used in all areas of activity (enterprise management, support for managerial decision-making, employee training, etc.). The introduction of information technology can benefit the company in the following ways: increase revenues, increase productivity, reduce production time, reduce the number of employees, reduce the risks of errors and duplication of information in work. Positive results can be obtained only with the competent implementation and use of information technology in the company. To do this, you must first identify and eliminate all the obstacles to their implementation, and this, accordingly, requires a significant investment of time and experience of specialists in this field. [1, 2]

The relevance of this work lies in the need to improve the business process of interacting with customers, increase the customer base, organize a single information space by introducing modern mobile technologies. The object of the study is the activities of the company (on the example, a travel agency) and the degree of its automation. The subject of the research is the processes of accumulation, processing, sorting, use of information when working with clients. The purpose of the work is to prepare recommendations for improving the business processes of interaction with clients of a travel agency. In this regard, a study of the activities of a travel agency and a description of business

processes for interacting with customers are carried out. Further development of the study is possible in the description of the company's business processes in the notation «as is». This will allow management to evaluate the effectiveness of existing business processes and develop a concept for their improvement «to be». To achieve the presented goal, an overview of literary sources was carried out, reflecting the need to improve business processes by automating them.

2. THEORETICAL AND METHODOLOGICAL ASPECTS OF AUTOMATING BUSINESS PROCESSES OF A COMPANY

Business automation is a complete or partial transition from manual execution of tasks to automatic using specialized tools. It can be various information systems or software systems. As a result of automation, there is a significant saving in labor human resources, finances, and the accuracy of the tasks performed is also increased. From a strategic point of view, any company always benefits from automation. With the help of automation, it is possible to establish a document flow of an enterprise, make automatic documents for clients and partners, and also receive reports on the financial or economic activities of the enterprise in a short time. [3]

Business automation is carried out in two directions: main processes and support processes. The main processes include sales management, customer base management. Automation of such processes is primarily aimed at increasing sales and increasing the number of customers. As support processes, accounting automation, work with documents, reporting are distinguished. Automation of such processes does not directly increase the organization's income, but creates the prerequisites for reducing costs and labor and time resources for operations. In addition, the automation of business processes helps to improve the quality of management in the company, as the number of people is reduced, production communications are simplified. Information is processed much faster; it does not require verification or endorsement. Repetitive tasks are performed without error. [4]

Implementation of business automation systems implies the creation or selection of software (software) that best suits the specifics of the company. The introduction of simple automation means installing software on work computers, connecting them together and building logical connections. It can also be a registration in a cloud service. Typically, such programs have an intuitive interface. Therefore, after their installation, personnel can immediately start working. [5]

If the company is large, and the management, marketing and production activities are complex, then the best solution would be to create software for your company. Such developments must be carried out in conjunction with a company providing business automation tools. Only specific employees and managers know the features of the processes that occur in the enterprise.

The more explain the requirements for developers, the more useful the automation program will be. After developing the software and installing it, it is necessary to make changes to the job descriptions of employees. Automation operations should be mandatory because many people are conservative and reluctant to use innovation. Then it is important to conduct staff training, to explain why the system is being introduced, how it works. Employees must understand how an automation system can help them do their job better. There are

certain risks in the implementation process. This is a big financial expense. The payback of automation systems is different for each business. It depends on many factors, therefore, when calculating the profitability of the introduction of such systems, one should not predict optimistic outcomes. Also, the complexity of implementing automation systems lies in the fact that staff may not accept it and will resist its use. Possible problems can be prevented if approach the process of implementing automation tools rationally: correctly identify needs, monitor the software market, select the right implementation partners. [1, 6]

Thus, the automation of the company's business processes is, of course, associated with the active use of modern innovative technologies and is aimed at digitalizing the company's activities.

Currently, information technologies penetrate and are actively used not only in everyday life (training, communication, etc.), but also in professional activities. It is impossible to imagine the manual processing, accumulation, transmission, retrieval, storage of information in science, trade, production, economics, management, medicine, education, politics and other areas of human activity. Network, mobile, cloud technologies are increasingly being used, which automate the management of organizations of various sizes and different types of activities. The effectiveness of such management directly depends not only on the IT used, but also on the applied professional software. For the solution of this problem is devoted to scientific and practical research of various authors [1, 3, 7-11].

The tourism business is a mobile line business - its representatives need to constantly be in touch with customers, coordinate any situation remotely, be able to quickly respond to any questions, etc. An important aid to a travel agency will be, for example, a specially developed mobile application for the tourism industry. However, despite the development of information systems, these technologies are not a significant enough tool in the modern tourism business of Russia. While information technologies abroad are an integral part of some major tourism and socio-cultural projects. Among IT developers and the most advanced participants in the tourism market, including the Russian one, are already actively working on the introduction and adaptation of mobile technologies to optimize their business and improve the quality of services for those ist. [12]

A mobile gadget with a modern operating system and a set of programs useful for travelers will save time and money, find sights and become an indispensable assistant during trips. Mobile technologies can significantly help travel agencies, giving them the opportunity to expand the range of services for customers. Therefore, many companies, including those on the Russian market, offer SMS notifications about changes in flight schedules, details and booking status. Mobile technology plays a very important role in the field of sales, for example, paying for air travel from your mobile phone and getting the necessary bar code for registration and boarding the plane. [4, 7, 11]

Thus, the use of innovative digital technologies to automate the business processes of any company will provide significant positive results. Given the characteristics of the company's activities, management should make the best decision when choosing the technologies used. Studies show that the most popular are network, cloud and mobile technologies. However, before offering any innovations in the company, it is necessary to conduct a thorough analysis of its activities and business strategies, since automation

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of any business processes should not be carried out to the detriment of the main activity. [5, 8]

Thus, in order to increase the competitiveness of a travel agency, it is advisable to use modern technologies for automating customer interactions. For example, the introduction and use of remote access to the services offered will expand the customer base. This is due to the creation of the most comfortable conditions for potential customers: the exclusion of a personal visit to the office of the company significantly saves customers time. In this regard, it is advisable for the management of the company to prepare a project for automating business processes of interacting with customers. However, for this it is necessary to analyze the activities of the company and a description of the business processes for interacting with customers in the form that carried out is currently. The description will allow to prepare an analysis of strengths and weaknesses, as well as develop recommendations for automation.

3. ANALYSIS OF THE ACTIVITIES AND BUSINESS PROCESSES OF THE COMPANY

3.1. Description the activities of the company

Any travel company is forced to constantly respond to changes in the market: lagging behind the more successful and perspicacious threatens with mistrust of customers, which can lead to a decrease in the overall image of the company, to the loss of a significant part regular customers. In this work, a description and analysis of the company activities is carried out on the example of a limited liability company (LLC) travel agency «1001 tour», which carefully monitors all changes in the tourism market, studies the activities of competing firms, and develops new tourist routes for youth, family, business, educational, medical tourism; conducts numerous surveys on its websites on the Internet and among the population.

A review of Internet sources showed that Travel Agency «1001 tour» is an legal entity and builds its activities in strict accordance with the Charter and regulatory documents of the Russian Legislation. Since LLC «1001 tour» is a commercial organization, the purpose of its activity is to make a profit from a tourist activity. This agency is licensed to carry out related activities. [13]

The mission of the travel agency is to create the conditions for quality relaxation and healthy leisure, with the aim of expanding horizons and getting new, bright and positive emotions.

Travel agency goals:

1. The company should strive for a stable position in the market by identifying and promoting competitive advantages.
2. Achieving long-term cooperation with any client who contacted the company.
3. The increase in travel agency profits.

Each company adheres to a specific strategy to achieve its goals and fulfill the mission. In a general sense, strategy is a means to achieve the desired results. The travel agency strategy «1001 tour» is constantly evolving, so it is always aimed at action, and the process of improving the strategy is endless. A main place in the planning organization of the activity of the travel agency «1001 tour» is promising, strategic planning, which is one of the main management functions and represents the process of determining

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the goals of creating an organization, as well as ways to achieve them. Strategic planning forms the basis for all management decisions. The functions of the organization, motivation and control of management are focused on the development and implementation of strategic plans. The dynamic process of strategic planning is the basis for all management functions. Without using the advantages of strategic planning, the company and its individual employees will be deprived of a real way of assessing the goals and direction of the enterprise. The strategic planning process provides the basis for managing the team of the travel agency «1001 tour».

The key elements of a travel agency strategy are presented in Figure 1 as a tree of goals. The strategic goal is to increase the company's profits not by any means and methods, but by improving work with customers, contractors, and staff.



Figure 1. Target tree of the travel agency «1001 tour».

Travel agency «1001 tour» has an organizational structure determined by the mission, goals, objectives, directions and types of activities and is presented in Figure 2. All divisions of the company are to varying degrees automated by modern information technologies (computer equipment, local network, software). A study of the organizational structure, technical and software of the company is necessary in order to carry out modeling and analysis of the main business processes, as well as to determine proposals for their improvement and/or development in accordance with the purpose and mission of the company.

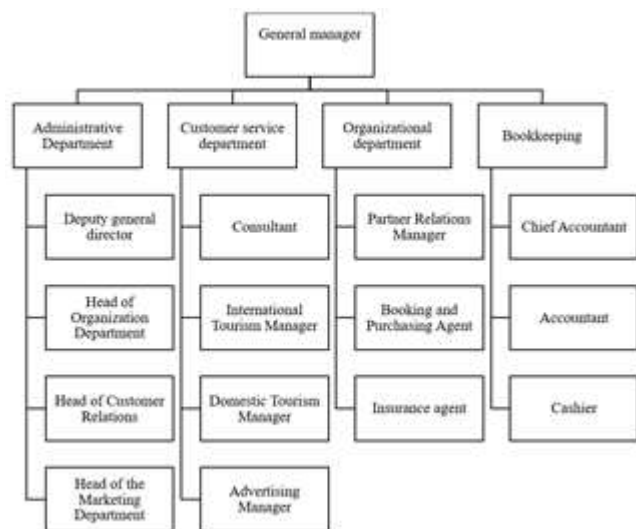


Figure 2. Organizational structure of the travel agency «1001 tour».

Thus, a description of the company's activities, its mission, strategy, goals was carried out to highlight business processes that need to be improved. For example, to increase the number of company customers. However, first of all, it is necessary to conduct an analysis of the activities of the company under study, which will determine the strengths and weaknesses of the company.

3.2. Analysis of the activities of the company

To assess the internal and external factors affecting the efficiency of the company, it is advisable to use the SWOT analysis, which is a preliminary research stage in the preparation of strategic plans, the development of strategic goals and objectives of the company. It is believed that companies cannot control and evaluate external factors until internal ones are objectively evaluated. Strengths and weaknesses should be considered, both from an internal point of view, and from the point of view of customers and competitors. The influence of external circumstances on each organization and individual is very strong. Often they affect the business directly or indirectly. It is important to know and document each of them. External factors are, as a rule, those circumstances that the company cannot control: market trends (new products, technologies, changes in the needs of the target audience); economic trends (local, national, international financial trends); financing (donations, government influences, taxes, etc.); demographic data (age, gender, race, nationality, cultural values of the target audience); relationships with suppliers and partners; political, environmental, economic situation in the country. [4, 9, 14]

Table 1 presents the results of a SWOT analysis of travel agency activities, which were obtained during a review of online sources and as a result of a personal visit as a client. This data can be used to model business processes of customer relationships and identify specific proposals for their improvement using information technology.

Table 1. SWOT-analysis of the activities of the travel agency «1001 tour»

Strengths	Weaknesses
1. Availability of necessary financial resources 2. High professionalism of tour sale staff 3. A wide range of tours 4. Flexible pricing 5. Good location	1. Staff: no delegation 2. Lack of a well-defined strategy 3. Ineffective advertising 4. Significant impact of seasonality on earnings 5. Lag in the use of information systems
Opportunities	Threats
1. A wide selection of suppliers of resources in all areas - air, railway, insurance, financial companies, tour operators 2. Seasonal demand growth 3. Support for tourism activities by the state 4. Weakening competitors 5. Increased market growth 6. Operations via the Internet 7. Serving new customer groups 8. Strengthening the reputation of the company	1. The possibility of the emergence of new competitors 2. Decrease in solvency of the population 3. The unstable political situation in countries that are in great demand among consumers 4. Decrease in seasonal demand (in the winter) 5. The ban of the state on certain tours

The SWOT analysis is an assessment of the strengths and weaknesses of the travel agency «1001 tour», its capabilities and external threats. The purpose of its conduct was to study the actual situation and strategic prospects of the company based on the study of its strengths and weaknesses, market opportunities and risk factors. When developing a strategy, it is necessary to ensure compliance with the internal state of the company (i.e., the balance of its strengths and weaknesses) the external situation (i.e. the conditions of the industry and competition).

A SWOT analysis of the activities of the travel agency «1001 tour» showed that the company needs:

- pay attention to maintaining the customer base and a stable financial position;
- control prices, develop a personality-oriented approach in working with clients, including by introducing modern digital technologies;
- increase the use of the capabilities of modern information technologies (network, mobile, etc.);
- reduce the impact of negative factors, especially in relationships with customers.

Thus, the analysis of the activities of the travel agency «1001 tour» showed the need to describe business processes related to customer service of the company. In the future, this will allow the company's management to develop «as is» and «to be» business models, and then provide recommendations and suggestions for further research on improving these business processes using information technology.

3.3. Description of company business processes

A description of a company's business processes is usually carried out by analysts or specialists from the implementation department who may encounter a number of difficulties: a large number of undescribed processes, a lack of understanding of the need for a description of a company's business processes by employees, or even their active resistance to automation. This can be a serious obstacle to rapid implementation. The task of analyzing the activities of the company is to deeply study the main (affecting profit) business processes. At the stage of describing the company's business processes, a fundamental understanding of the essence of the work of all employees is important: what work they do, what they are responsible for, whether the resources spent correspond to the result produced by the employee, and, accordingly, where the «weak link» is in the process. [7, 9, 11, 15]

The study of the characteristics and types of activities of the travel agency «1001 tour» showed that the company has a small number of employees, some of which perform a rather large set of functions and operations and bear an increased responsibility for the correct and timely customer service. Figure 3 shows a schematic representation of the business processes of a travel agency.



Figure 3. The list of business processes of the travel agency «1001 tour».

Allocate the main, supporting, service and management business processes. As a rule, interaction with customers is referred to the main business processes that affect the efficiency of the company. Therefore, in the first place, it is these business processes that need to be described and analyzed.

Interaction with clients of the travel company «1001 tour» is carried out in the framework of two main business processes:

1. Sale of tourist permits - can be depicted as an end-to-end process (Figure 4), which involves several performers in the work.



Figure 4. Scheme of the business process of the sale of tourist permits in the travel agency «1001 tour».

2. Organization of tours - also represents an end-to-end process (Figure 5) with the participation of several performers



Figure 5. Scheme of the business process of organizing tours in the travel agency «1001 tour».

A schematic representation of the investigated basic business processes showed that the operations performed are not complicated for company employees. However, are observed routine operations and a significant probability of possible mechanical errors. In addition, there is a significant investment of time by customers. In this regard, it is necessary to develop a detailed model of business processes in the notation «as is», conduct an analysis and develop a model of business processes in the notation «to be». However, it is necessary to pay attention to the fact that the complexity of improving the main business process of any company lies in the need not to interfere with the daily work of the company - stopping work with clients even for just a few hours can lead to loss of customers and losses to the company.

4. CONCLUSION

Thus, the description and analysis of the travel agency's activities and its main business processes showed the need to use modern information technologies (mobile applications) to increase the customer base, reduce the time for employees to interact with customers, strengthen their positions among competitors, which will lead to an increase in travel agency profits.

It is advisable to conduct modeling of business processes «as is» and «to be». This will make all operations of the company transparent and understandable, allow to analyze operations and detect problems in them that lead to failures. The main thing is that business process models will help to understand the interaction between employees and departments at each stage. This approach (process) will greatly simplify the adaptation of new employees and reduce the dependence of the company on the human factor. The presence of a well-developed system of business processes greatly simplifies bringing the company's activities in line with quality standards GOST ISO 9001-2015, which is an important competitive advantage.

As a result of the study of the activities of the travel agency «1001 tour» based on Internet sources and as a result of personal visits, not sufficiently effective interaction with customers was revealed. An analysis of the company's activities showed the potential for the development of the company, and especially in improving the business process of interacting with customers. In this regard, it is advisable to recommend the introduction and use of mobile technologies, which will reduce the time spent on interacting with customers by reducing the number of personal visits to the company's office. In addition, the use of a mobile application will make the investigated business processes the most transparent for managers, employees, customers. However, for the effective improvement of the studied business processes, it is advisable to develop their detailed models in the notions «as is» and «to be». The next step should be the preparation of the project indicating the work performed and assessing the economic efficiency of this project.

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